

313 Make a fake fossil

40
MINS

Real fossils can take millions of years to form, but you can make a real-looking “fossil” in one day with this project. Use a shell, a handprint, a toy, or an actual fossil.

What you need

• Modeling clay • Water • Petroleum jelly • Posterboard strip • Item to fossilize • Plaster of Paris • Small plastic container • Yellow or red food coloring



1 Shape modeling clay into a thick, flat disk. Rub petroleum jelly on top. Press your object into the clay, then take it out.



2 Push the posterboard strip into the modeling clay around the mold. Mix the plaster and color it with a few drops of food coloring.

A real ammonite was used here



3 Let the plaster thicken, then pour it into the mold. Let it set for a day. Carefully remove your “fossil.” Use it as a paperweight.



314 Look for shaped stones

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The next time you're at a pebbly beach, search for shaped stones. Heart shapes are fairly easy to find, but look carefully enough and you may find other familiar shapes.



STONE
HEARTS